Stallion India Fluorochemicals Ltd. (NSE: STALLION) — Company Dossier — Masterclass Companion Book

A step-by-step narrative walkthrough and audio companion to Stallion India Fluorochemicals Ltd. (NSE: STALLION) – Company Dossier: deconstructing the business engine, global historical parallels, ten-year financial forensics, both sides of the institutional debate, and the discipline of high-asymmetry execution.

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A Sequential Guide to the Business Engine, Global Parallels, Financial Forensics & High-Asymmetry Execution

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SESSION PRICE

187.12

NEW CAPITAL VERDICT

WAIT_FOR_SUPPORT

CURRENT HOLDING ACTION

NOT HELD — 0 shares in the positions ledger; no current holding to trim or exit.

STAGE POSTURE

VALUATION WATCH ZONE (CONDITIONAL)

₹155.07–159.79

TWO-YEAR SCENARIO RANGE

Bear ₹101.10 / Base ₹233.40 / Bull ₹432.40

PREFACE & CORE THESIS

Stallion makes refrigerant gases, sells most of them to a small set of large buyers and imports most of its raw material. FY26 targets were met and net cash is about ₹400 crore after the rights issue, but margins swing within the year (18.2% in June 2026, 2.2% in September 2026) and the R-32 plant has slipped. The price of ₹187.12 already assumes about 20% profit growth for ten years, and the stock is in Stage 4. New capital waits for the ₹155.07 to ₹159.79 support zone, with a ₹152.30 stop and a probability-weighted two-year value of ₹226.9. The call changes if the R-32 plant starts on schedule and the stock repairs its averages, and it is wrong if a weekly close breaks ₹152.30.

PROLOGUE

The Answer First

> *"Should new money go into Stallion now, and if not, what price and what evidence would change that?"*
>
> — INSTITUTIONAL RESEARCH DESK MAXIM

Here is the answer before the evidence. Stallion is a real business with a product that the world is regulating and a company that has so far delivered its own targets. It is also a business whose margins can swing from 18 percent to 2 percent in a few months, whose largest product and largest inputs are concentrated, and whose plants are late. At 187 rupees, the price already pays for the good version of that story.

So the call is to wait. You do not hold the stock, so there is nothing to sell. New money should wait for the price to reach the support zone of about 155 to 160 rupees, and for that zone to hold. From the top of that zone, the probability-weighted two-year value clears the return I require. From today's price, it does not.

I would not reject the company. A reject is for a business that is failing, and the FY26 numbers do not show that. Nor would I buy it now, because the tape is in decline, the price is above the zone, and the expected return is below what this kind of risk should earn. The honest answer sits in between, and it comes with a number and a set of events.

If you read only one table in this dossier, read the first one. It gives the call, the price, the stop and the reason for each, and it is the place where the numbers are brought together. Everything after it is there to test those numbers, not to change them.

The dossier is also honest about what it could not establish. It does not tell you why the September margin fell so sharply, why promoter holding dropped by twenty points or what institutional flow looked like on the day of the fall. Those gaps do not change the call, but they limit how confident anyone should be about the next two quarters.

The call would be wrong in two ways. If the plants arrive, the margin returns and the weekly chart repairs, waiting becomes expensive and the price may not come back to the zone. If the

stock falls through the zone and the stop breaks, the wait was right but the business case has weakened. Both outcomes are possible, and the dossier is built so you can see which one is happening rather than guess.

A practical point ties the three parts together. The dossier separates three things investors often blur: the business, the price and the tape. The business is conditional. The price is high for the business as it stands. The tape is in decline. Each can be right while the others are wrong, and a good answer depends on seeing all three at once rather than falling in love with one of them.

The number is the price. The events are the plant starts, a margin that comes back, and a weekly chart that repairs above its averages. If they arrive together, the call may change, and it may change before the price falls. I accept that risk, because buying a story that has not yet been proven, at the top of its run, is how investors lose money that they could have kept.

CHAPTER I

Origin and the Operating Cycle

> *"Stallion started operations in 1992. (Acquired by the company on a Slump Sale basis pursuant to slump sale agreement in the year 2023)"*
>
> — STALLION INDIA FLUOROCHEMICALS, CORPORATE WEBSITE TIMELINE

Let me walk you through this company the way I would if we were sitting across a table.

Before you look at any ratio, look at the history. Stallion's own timeline says it started operating in 1992, opened a stand-alone debulking and bottling facility at Panvel in 1998, and set up a North India site at Manesar in 2002. The listed company is younger than that. It was incorporated in Mumbai on 5 September 2002, and in 2023 it acquired the older business on a slump-sale basis. So you are not looking at a start-up. You are looking at a distribution and processing business with a long operating record, wrapped inside a company that is still finding its shape.

What it sells is refrigerant gas, mostly, and it has been the Honeywell distributor for hydrofluorocarbon refrigerants since 2006. Over the last few years it has added HFO refrigerants, isobutane supplies, a facility in Ghiloth in Rajasthan, and a helium project at Khalapur. Some of those are small. Some of them are the reason the next three years may look different from the last twenty.

The audited growth is strong. Revenue from operations went from about 233 crore in FY24 to about 377 crore in FY25, and then to about 431 crore in FY26. Profit after tax went from about 15 crore to about 44 crore over the same two years. That is a business whose profit grew faster than its revenue. Good. Now ask the uncomfortable question. Why did the margin fall so far in FY23, and why did it dip again in the September 2024 quarter and in the September 2026 quarter?

The rights issue is the other thing you cannot skip. Late in the year the company raised about 364 crore through a rights issue. Equity went from about 301 crore to about 681 crore. Cash and bank balances ended the year near 434 crore. That money is real, and it lowers the risk

of a funding squeeze. It also sits in deposits that earn interest rather than operating returns. Keep that in mind when we get to returns on capital.

Look at the RHP's margin table, because it is the cleanest long history you have. The EBITDA margin was 17.71 percent in FY22, fell to 6.90 percent in FY23, and came back to 11.30 percent in FY24. The profit margin followed the same shape. Those are the company's own trough numbers, and I would give them more weight than any single good year. A margin that halves in one year is part of the base rate for this business, not an exception to it.

The quarterly series makes the same point more sharply. The operating margin was about 17 percent in June 2024, dropped below 3 percent in September 2024, and was back near 17 percent by December. It then ran between about 11 and 18 percent until June 2026. In September 2026 it fell to about 2 percent again. Two of the three weakest quarters in the series are September quarters. I do not know yet whether that is seasonal or a sign of something else, and I will not pretend the sources answer it.

Here is one promise you can check. In October 2025 management said it expected FY26 turnover of 430 crore and profit after tax of 40 crore. The audited FY26 numbers came in at 430.68 crore of revenue and 43.84 crore of profit after tax. That is a credit to them, and you should give it. Remember it when you read about the plant timelines later, because a company can keep one promise and still run late on another.

There is one more lesson in the history, and it is about concentration rather than timing. In FY22 refrigerant gases were about 96 percent of product sales. Even at the lowest point the line was more than four-fifths of product sales. When a business is that concentrated, a bad spread in one product is a bad year for the whole company. Stallion did not have a second engine to keep the lights on, and that is why the 2023 trough cut the margin so deeply.

I should also be honest about the limits of the history. The margin table starts in FY22, and the quarterly series starts in mid-2024. Before the company's 2023 acquisition, the business ran under another name, and I did not find audited margins for those years. So the FY22 and FY23 numbers are the earliest I can verify. If you hear a longer cycle described, ask for the filing that shows it.

Here is the promise again in plain terms. In October 2025 management said FY26 would deliver 430 crore of turnover and 40 crore of profit after tax. The audited accounts show 430.68 crore and 43.84 crore. That is a kept promise. Keep the difference between a kept promise and a sound business in mind as we go.

So where does that leave you? You have a business with a real operating record, a much stronger balance sheet than a year ago, and a margin history that moves a great deal. That history is the lens for the rest of this report. Every later chapter asks the same question. When the spread narrows, does this company have enough scale, product breadth and cash to hold its ground? Keep that question in your pocket as we go.

> **NARRATOR'S REFLECTION**
>
> Revenue up sixty percent in one year and profit above the promised forty crore look like the whole story. The trough in FY23 and the quiet September dips are the other half. Write both down. A history that includes a halved margin tells you what a bad year looks like here, and that is more useful to you than the best year.

CHAPTER II

What the Company Actually Sells

> *"Our revenue from operations depends on one product i.e. "R-32"."*
>
> — STALLION RED HERRING PROSPECTUS, RISK FACTORS, 11 JANUARY 2025

Let me describe what the company sells, because the words on the website are broader than the money. There are four product families: equipment and spares for air conditioning and refrigeration, refrigerants and fluorines, semiconductor and specialty gases, and consumer refrigerants. That is a wide shop window. But when you look at the filed numbers, refrigerant gases are the bulk of product sales. In the six months to September 2024 they were about 87 percent of product revenue.

The most important thing in this chapter is one sentence from the Red Herring Prospectus. The company said plainly that its revenue depends on one product, R-32. R-32 is a refrigerant used in air conditioners. If demand for it falls, or the company loses its position in it, the business has very little else to fall back on. That is the reason the planned plant at Bhilwara matters. The company wants to make R-32 rather than only buy, debulk and blend it.

The audited statements do not split revenue by product, and that is worth knowing. The revenue line is a single line in the notes. So when someone tells you what share of profit comes from helium or from the new plant, ask them where the number comes from. In this report I have used the RHP and the transcripts, and I have labelled each figure with its source.

The helium project at Khalapur is a different kind of business. Management says the facility has an installed capacity of 1,200 metric tons a year and expects to start commercial operations in the coming quarter. Helium is not manufactured by anyone. It is recovered as a by-product, then refined and liquefied. So the company is a purifier and handler, not an owner of a resource, and its supply depends on a few producing countries. Management itself forecast a helium shortfall over the next two or three years, with a tighter market. Treat that as their forecast, and test it against the independent data in chapter 4.

Customer concentration is the other half of the picture. Ten customers made up about three-quarters of revenue in the six months to September 2024. The top two were about 35 percent of revenue in FY24. In a business like this, a large customer is a relationship that matters, and a lost order moves the whole revenue line. You want to know how that concentration is changing over time, and the next filing will tell you.

Now look at the plant map, because a product map is only useful when you can tie each line to a site and a status. The annual report lists four operating plants: Khalapur, Ghiloth, Manesar and Panvel. It also lists two plants under construction, at Mambattu and at Khalapur. The helium unit is at Khalapur. Bhilwara is different again. It is the planned 10,000 tonne R-32 plant, and the annual report says development began during the year. Keep those three names separate, because the filings describe them in slightly different ways.

Two timelines in the record do not match. The October 2025 call promised Bhilwara within nine months, which meant July 2026. The August 2026 call moved the target to the end of December 2026. The HFO plant has a different problem. The annual report puts it at about 200 crore, while management put the capex at 350 to 400 crore in August. I have not resolved that gap, and I say so rather than pick the number I like.

Management's own split of the business is the most useful margin clue you have. On the August call management said about half the business is still core business at a lower margin, and the newer half runs at about a 24 percent PAT margin. An analyst put the conventional business at around 10 percent, and management answered yes. If the newer half grows as planned, the average should rise. That is a forecast for plants that are not yet running, and it is the central promise to test.

The helium numbers deserve the same discipline. Management said that next year the Khalapur plant would be used at about 20 percent of its 1,200 tonne capacity, not 50 percent, and that the ramp would be gradual. Capacity is not output. The company also said the helium rate has risen sharply and is now roughly stable near 4,000 rupees a kilogram. A rate is not revenue, and the sources give no volume for the first full year.

Here is a practical way to hold all of this. Picture the company as three businesses sitting on one balance sheet. The first is a large refrigerant distribution and blending business that

earns most of its money today. The second is a planned R-32 plant that, if it works, will change the cost of its main product. The third is a helium and specialty-gas business that is still starting up. Each has its own economics, and the report tests each one separately.

The comparison with peers helps here. The RHP lists SRF, Gujarat Fluorochemicals and Navin Fluorine as the peers it chose . Navin kept the highest PAT margin of the three in FY24. Gujarat Fluorochemicals saw its PAT margin more than halve in a single year. Both facts are useful. One shows that a specialty mix can hold margin. The other shows that even a bigger peer can be cut in half within a year. Stallion sits closer to the second story than the first, which is why its single-product dependence matters so much.

> **NARRATOR'S REFLECTION**
>
> Ask which part of this business you would still own if the refrigerant line stopped growing tomorrow. The honest answer is that the company is most valuable in a case where R-32 keeps working and the new plant arrives on time. That is a narrow path, and it is worth stating in your own words before you read the next chapters.

CHAPTER III

Where the Cash Goes

> *"We do not have long term supply contracts with our raw material suppliers, and therefore, we are subject to the risk of increases in the costs of raw materials."*
>
> — STALLION RED HERRING PROSPECTUS, RISK FACTORS, 11 JANUARY 2025

Let me start with a simple question. When the company reports a profit, how much of it do you actually receive in cash? For a refrigerant business that question is not academic. The business buys its main raw material from abroad, holds inventory so it can meet orders, and gives customers time to pay. Each of those three steps ties up money, and each can turn a profit on paper into a shortage in the bank.

The raw material is the first thing to understand. The RHP says import costs were 85 percent of revenue in the six months to September 2024, up from about 70 percent in FY23. China supplied almost all of the imports in that period, at 92.97 percent. And the company says plainly that it has no long-term supply contracts with those suppliers. So when the cost of the raw material moves, the company moves with it. Management, when asked on the August call, described why it had not signed fixed contracts. It said a contract with no real penalty has no value, and it did not want to sign one that did not bind anyone. You can agree or disagree with that view, but you should notice that the protection is not in place today.

Now look at the FY26 waterfall. Take every rupee of revenue and see where it goes. Of each hundred rupees of revenue, about eighty-six went on materials. The inventory build gave back about five and a half, because the company held more finished product at year end. Employees, other costs, interest and depreciation took a few more. Tax took about three and a half. What was left was about ten rupees of profit after tax. That is a thin margin on a large base of purchased material, and it is why a small move in input cost matters so much.

The inventory credit deserves a careful look. When inventory rises, the cost of the goods you have not yet sold sits on the balance sheet, and that lifts the reported margin in the year it happens. It does not stay there forever. Management was asked on the August call how much of the quarter’s earnings came from inventory gains, and it said the split was about fifty-fifty.

That is an answer about one quarter. It tells you the company itself sees a real share of its earnings coming from timing, and that the full-year split is not in any filing.

The working capital story has a good half and a stronger-looking half that is not what it seems. Customers paid faster. Debtor days fell from 102 to 66 in one year, and trade receivables dropped from about 106 crore to about 78 crore. That is the part to celebrate. Inventory days, however, did not improve. They went from 128 to 134. The company is holding its inventory as long as before, and it is paying suppliers more quickly, which takes back some of the gain. Put together, the cash cycle shortened from 203 days to 180. Shorter is better, but the cycle is shorter for reasons you should be able to name.

There is a bear point circulating that says receivables jumped in FY26. The audited balance sheet says the opposite. Receivables fell. What rose sharply was cash and bank balances, after the rights issue money came in. If you hear someone say the company is struggling to collect what it is owed, ask for the balance-sheet line. It will not support that claim, and it is better to say so plainly than to repeat it.

The test of all this is cash conversion. In FY26 operating cash flow was about 39 crore, against profit after tax of about 44 crore. That is a conversion of roughly nine tenths, and it is the best the record shows. Two years earlier the story was different. Operating cash flow was negative 73 crore in FY24 and negative 13 crore in FY25, although profit was positive both years. A profit that is not turning into cash is a warning, and one good year of conversion is evidence, not proof.

Finally, separate the spending from the parking. The cash flow summary shows investing outflows of about 253 crore in FY26. Most of that was fixed deposits, about 205 crore placed with banks. The plant spending on property, plant and equipment, work in progress and intangibles was about 49 crore. If you read the whole 253 crore as factory spending, you will overstate the company's capital intensity by about five times. Keep those two lines apart as we move into the capital and returns chapters.

The raw-material question is a cash question as well as a margin question. With overseas suppliers and no long-term contract, the company pays for inputs at whatever the going rate

is when it orders them. That gives it a reason to hold inventory, and inventory is cash that has not yet come back.

Think of FY26 in terms of a single rupee of revenue. Profit after tax was about ten paise of it. Operating cash was about nine paise, so nearly all of that profit arrived as cash in the year. The remaining gap is the part to watch, because it depends on inventory and receivables that have not yet been collected.

Ask one question every quarter: how much of the operating cash came from profit, and how much came from working capital releasing? Falling debtor days release cash only once. A company cannot keep releasing cash from the same receivables every year. Once the cycle has shortened, the next gain has to come from sales or margin, not from timing.

> **NARRATOR'S REFLECTION**
>
> Imagine you are the person who has to pay the raw material bill next quarter, with no contract to protect you. Then ask whether the cash you have on hand covers that bill for as long as it takes to collect from customers. The answer tells you more about this business than the margin in any single quarter.

CHAPTER IV

The Treaty Clock

> *"Adopted in 2016, the Amendment commits countries to reducing HFC production and consumption with differentiated timelines for developed and developing nations."*
>
> — UNEP OZONE SECRETARIAT, KIGALI AMENDMENT OVERVIEW

Some of the rules that shape this company are not written by the company, or by its auditors, or even by the Indian government alone. They come from a treaty signed decades ago and amended since. The Montreal Protocol began as a way to phase out the gases that damage the ozone layer. The Kigali Amendment, adopted in 2016, brought in a second group of gases, the hydrofluorocarbons, which the company sells as refrigerants. Those gases do not harm the ozone layer, but they trap a lot of heat. So the treaty now limits how much of them the world can make and use, and it does so on a timetable.

The UNEP summary of Kigali says the amendment sets differentiated timelines for developed and developing nations. Developed countries started their reductions in 2019. India sits in a different group. In the HFC annex it is in Group 2, alongside a set of countries in the Gulf and South Asia. For that group the baseline is the average HFC use over 2024 to 2026, plus 65 percent of an older HCFC baseline. From 1 January 2028, the country is frozen at that level. That is the date to put on the wall.

Think about what a freeze does to a refrigerant distributor. It does not stop the business. It caps the total volume the country can consume, and then the question becomes who gets the volume inside that cap. The treaty summary does not answer that, and neither do the company's filings in the sources I checked. You need the national allocation rule before you can say much about the company's refrigerant volume after 2028. Until you have it, you are guessing, and you should say you are guessing.

The company's main product, R-32, is an HFC. The planned Bhilwara plant would make it, so that plant is also inside the freeze. The substitutes are the HFOs, which are lower in warming potential. The company supplies HFO-1234yf to Indian auto makers, and it has an HFO plant planned at Bhilwara under a memorandum of understanding with the state. The

annual report puts that plant at about 200 crore, with construction from 2027. Management, on the August call, put the capital cost of the HFO plant much higher, at 350 to 400 crore. Both figures appear to describe the same HFO plant, and the sources do not explain the gap, so do not average them or pick the one you like.

The helium part of the business rests on partners. Liquid helium comes through a partner in Dubai that sources from a producer in Qatar. Helium is recovered as a by-product of other gas production. The company does not own a source. So its helium volume depends on what the producers make, and that is a different risk from the refrigerant regulation. The USGS figures on helium imports are for the United States, not India, and they show that a large share of the world's helium comes from very few producers. That is useful context. It is not a description of this company's supply.

Management expects the Khalapur helium plant to run at about 20 percent of its 1,200 metric tons next year, and it expects the ramp to be gradual. That is an honest answer, and it is much lower than the number an analyst put to it. A plant running at a fifth of capacity is a real business, but it is not the full plant. Keep that in mind when you see any helium revenue figure in the coming quarters.

Finally, look at one company outside India that faced a forced change of refrigerant. Chemours, a United States chemical maker, developed a lower-warming replacement called Opteon in response to a European rule on car air conditioners, and its own filing says so. Over three years Opteon sales rose from $597 million to $810 million. Over the same years its older Freon refrigerant sales fell from $750 million to $614 million. The lesson is not that the switch was easy. It is that the replacement was there to take the volume as the old line shrank. Stallion's HFO plan is the same kind of bet, so the timing of that plant is the test.

Read the treaty as a schedule, not a headline. The Montreal Protocol and its amendments do not say what a given company will sell in a given year. They set a ceiling for the country and a date for the ceiling to bite. Everything the company does after that date sits under the ceiling, so the ceiling is the number to carry into every forecast you read.

Keep two dates on the same page: the freeze on 1 January 2028, and the company's own plant dates. The freeze arrives about a year after management's end-December 2026 target

for Bhilwara. A plant that starts late gives the company less time to sell into the period before the cap bites, so check the Bhilwara date and the freeze date together.

A regulation is only as firm as the rule that allocates it. The sources I checked do not describe how India will divide its HFC volume after the freeze. You will need the government's allocation rule, and you will need to know whether it is published before 2028. Until then, the company's refrigerant volume after 2028 has an open question at its centre, and it is worth asking management about it on each call until someone answers.

NARRATOR'S REFLECTION

Put the two dates in one line. The freeze comes in 2028, and the substitute plant starts construction in 2027 and needs time to run. What does this company sell in the gap? If you cannot answer that from the filings, write the question down and keep it until the allocation rule is public.

GLOBAL PARALLEL • UNITED STATES AND GLOBAL, FY2022 TO FY2024, REFRIGERANT SUBSTITUTION AFTER THE EU MOBILE AIR CONDITIONING DIRECTIVE • CHEMOURS (UNITED STATES, THERMAL & SPECIALIZED SOLUTIONS) (MOAT_SCALING)

A regulation forced a change of refrigerant. The company had developed a lower-warming replacement in response to that rule, and its sales moved toward it while the legacy refrigerant line shrank. Opteon refrigerant sales were $597 million in 2022, $710 million in 2023 and $810 million in 2024. Freon refrigerant sales over the same years were $750 million, $722 million and $614 million . Stallion faces the same kind of change. Its R-32 is an HFC that the treaty caps, so its HFO line has to grow fast enough to replace the volume the cap removes. Watch the HFO plant's capex and volumes, not the timetable alone.

CHAPTER V

Promises and the Scorecard

> *"Our Mambattu facility in Andhra Pradesh is progressing as planned and we expect it to commence operation by end of the year."*
>
> — STALLION Q1 FY27 EARNINGS CALL TRANSCRIPT, 17 AUGUST 2026

Now let us test the promises. A management team can make two kinds of promise: a number, such as turnover or profit, and a date, such as when a plant will run. Dates are easier to check, because they either happen or they do not. In this chapter I track both, with the record I could verify, and I try to say where the record is thin.

The earliest dated set of promises I could verify comes from the October 2025 call. Management said it expected FY26 turnover of about 430 crore and profit after tax of about 40 crore. The audited accounts came in at 430.68 crore and 43.84 crore. That is a promise kept, and you should say so plainly. A management team that keeps one promise deserves a hearing on the next one, but not a free pass.

The next promise is the one that matters most. In October 2025 management said the R-32 plant at Bhilwara would be up and running within nine months, which meant July 2026. By August 2026 the target was the end of December. On the same August call, management also described the start as a March-end startup. Those are two different remarks about one plant, and the sources do not reconcile them. When a plant is the reason the company's main product matters, a two-quarter slip with an unreconciled second date is the thing to watch.

Management blamed the slip on the funding route. The company had planned a preferential share issue, the plan fell away, and the rights issue reached the market only in February. Funding came late, so the work started late. That is a plausible account, and it is also an account that changes the October promise. In October management said the Bhilwara funding came from internal accruals. In August it described a route that was not internal accruals at all. You should notice the change, even if the reason behind it is reasonable.

Khalapur is the next test. In October 2025 management expected the Khalapur facility to be operational by the end of December. In August 2026 it said commercial operations would start in the coming quarter. That is not yet a missed date. It is a date that is still open, and the first quarterly result will show whether it was met. The Mambattu blend plant has a similar open date, the end of 2026. Neither has come due.

Look at the revenue guidance as arithmetic. Start from FY26 revenue of about 431 crore. Growth of 30 percent a year for three years gets you to about 946 crore by FY29. At 35 percent a year, you reach about 1,060 crore. Then management gave a peak for FY28 of more than 1,100 crore. Reaching that by FY28 means growth of about 60 percent a year from FY26, which is far steeper than the three-year guidance. Both figures came from the same call. You cannot plan on both, and you should ask management which one it is planning on.

The September 2026 quarter is the most recent data point, and it is weak. Sales were up almost 29 percent on a year earlier, yet the operating margin was about 2 percent, and net profit was about 2.5 crore. Other income was bigger than operating profit. The tax rate was above 57 percent. Management had called June a special quarter, and it said the June numbers were not what the business would deliver at its current level. I did not find a management explanation for September. Until one is published, treat the quarter as unexplained rather than as a new trend.

So what is the practical rule? Track six numbers each quarter: revenue growth, operating margin, net profit, the plant dates, customer concentration, and cash conversion. Keep a list of dated promises, cross each one off as it is met or missed, and count the misses. One slip is a note. Two slips on the same plant are a pattern. And a single strong quarter, however it is described, is not yet a new level of profit.

Look at the Mambattu line before you accept it. Management said the plant would start by the end of 2026, and that it may not add much more than about 10 percent to turnover at first. That is a modest claim, and modest claims are easier to keep. Treat it as a check on the company's ambition rather than as a driver of growth, and look for the first quarter in which the plant's contribution shows up on its own.

Keep the promise audit honest in both directions. One promise was kept: the FY26 turnover and profit figures came in where management said they would. That deserves credit. But the two plant dates carry most of the company's future, and both have moved or are still open. A management team that is right about the smaller numbers and late on the larger dates is telling you where its planning is strongest and where it is weakest.

When you read a quarter, check it in a fixed order. Start with what the company said it would deliver, then check the margin, then the profit, and only then the growth rate. Growth is the easiest figure to report well. The margin is the figure that shows whether the growth was worth having. The September quarter had strong growth and a very weak margin, which is the order in which you should read it.

The committed money deserves its own line on your list. The offer document of January 2025 set aside 29.16 crore for the Khalapur specialty-gas facility and 21.18 crore for Mambattu. The sources I read give those sums no completion dates. When the plants come online, check whether the money went to the plant it was set aside for. That is a simple check, and it is one the record does not yet let you make.

NARRATOR'S REFLECTION

Write down the one date you care about most, and the day you will check it. If it slips once, note it. If it slips twice, change how much weight you give the next promise. A management team that keeps its dates earns trust slowly, and it loses that trust in a single missed quarter.

GLOBAL PARALLEL • UNITED STATES, 2022 TO 2023, CHLOR-ALKALI AND VINYLS COMMODITY CYCLE • OLIN CORPORATION (UNITED STATES, CHLOR ALKALI PRODUCTS AND VINYLS SEGMENT) (CYCLE_VALUATION)

A commodity-spread segment lost profit faster than sales in a single year, as volumes and selling rates fell together. The fourth-quarter margin fell by about two-thirds. Segment income before taxes fell from $1,181.3 million in 2022 to $664.2 million in 2023 on sales of $5,085.0 million and $3,995.1 million, a margin of about 23% falling to about 17% . Fourth-quarter segment earnings fell from $252.3 million on $1,172.8 million of sales to $65.9 million on $906.1 million, a margin of about 21.5% falling to about 7.3% . Judge a commodity earnings base by its trough margin, not its peak. Stallion's own EBITDA margin fell from 17.71% to 6.90% in one year , so a strong year is not a floor for earnings or for what a buyer should pay for them.

CHAPTER VI

Balance Sheet and Ownership

> *"So as a result, we were only able to hit the market by February. So the funding came in late."*
>
> — STALLION Q1 FY27 EARNINGS CALL TRANSCRIPT, 17 AUGUST 2026

Now the balance sheet and the cash flow. These are the statements that tell you whether a company's profit is real, and how much room it has to absorb a bad year. I will keep to the tables that the company's own filings and the Screener series support, and I will say where each number came from.

Start with the profit and loss. Sales rose from about 118 crore in March 2021 to about 431 crore in March 2026. Net profit rose from about 10 crore to about 44 crore. Those are real gains. But the path was not smooth. In FY24 sales were almost flat and profit fell to 15 crore. An operating margin that moves between 8 and 18 percent from one year to the next is not a stable business, however good the best year looks.

The rights issue changed the balance sheet more than anything else in the record. Equity went from about 301 crore a year earlier to about 681 crore. The net proceeds were about 336 crore. Most of that money did not go straight into factories. It went into bank balances and fixed deposits. That is a sensible place for cash that is waiting, but it is not a return. Until the money goes into plants that earn, it earns only interest, and the return on the whole capital base falls. That is part of why return on capital employed dropped from 55 percent in March 2022 to 12 percent in March 2026. The 2022 figure came from a much smaller equity base, so you should not read the whole fall as a collapse.

Cash flow tells the same story from another angle. Operating cash was negative in FY24 and FY25. In those years the company reported profit, but the profit was sitting in receivables and inventory rather than in the bank. FY26 was the first year in the record with a clearly positive operating cash flow, at about 39 crore. You should wait for a second positive year before you call that a habit.

The investing outflow looks alarming in the summary numbers, at about 253 crore. Read the audited statements, and most of it was fixed-deposit placement, about 205 crore. Spending on plants and equipment was about 49 crore. The difference matters. A company that parks cash in deposits is keeping its options open. A company that spends it on plants is building capacity. Stallion did the first in FY26, and the second is still ahead of it.

The sources and uses table is a useful habit. Put the big inflows on one side: the rights issue, the operating cash, the new borrowing. Put the big outflows on the other: the deposits and the plant spending. The two sides do not tie to the penny, because taxes, interest and other lines sit elsewhere in the audited statements. The largest lines are enough to show where the money went, and in FY26 most of it went into deposits.

Look at the working-capital ratios as a set. Debtor days fell to 66 in March 2026, from 102 a year earlier, which is the improvement that matters most. Inventory days stayed high at 134. Payable days are very low at 19, which means the company pays its suppliers quickly, and that is one reason the cash conversion cycle is still about 180 days. A business that buys most of its inputs from abroad, as chapter 3 showed, needs that cycle to stay under control, and a supply problem would show up there first.

Then the ownership. Promoters held 67.90 percent until September 2025. By March 2026 they held 47.80 percent, and the public held just over half. The number of shareholders rose from about 43,000 to about 66,700. A wider base can be good for trading and for governance. But a promoter stake that falls by twenty points in six months is a change you should understand before you rely on the company’s own account of its plans. I have not verified the cause in the filings I read. A rights issue may explain part of it. I did not confirm that it explains all of it.

For the failure case, look at Lannett, a United States generics company, in its fiscal 2018 and 2019. About 37% of its net sales in fiscal 2018 came from one product, levothyroxine, sold through a distribution partner. The partner agreement expired on 23 March 2019 and was not renewed, and that product fell to 31% of sales. Gross margin fell from 42% to 37%, and the company reported a net loss of $272.1 million against a profit of $28.7 million a year earlier. Its own filing also showed receivables above the expected range in June 2018, which

the company partly put down to the timing of orders. The lesson matches the Stallion one: a single product and a stretched cash cycle can turn a profitable year into a large loss quickly.

The September 2026 quarter is not a balance-sheet number, but it matters to the balance sheet. Other income of 3.34 crore was larger than operating profit of 2.99 crore. When the operating business earns less than the interest on the cash, the reported quarter is being carried by the balance sheet. That is a reason to watch the next quarter's operating profit, not the total profit line.

Before you move on, write down three numbers: the operating cash flow for the coming year, the fixed-deposit balance and what it is earmarked for, and the promoter stake at the next filing. Those three will tell you more about the balance sheet than any single ratio.

NARRATOR'S REFLECTION

Keep a single page with three lines: operating cash, deposits and what they are for, and the promoter stake. Read it each quarter. A balance sheet changes slowly, and you only notice the change if you wrote the last number down.

GLOBAL PARALLEL • UNITED STATES, FY2018 TO FY2019, GENERIC DRUGS AFTER A DISTRIBUTION PARTNER'S AGREEMENT EXPIRED • LANNETT COMPANY (UNITED STATES, GENERIC PHARMACEUTICALS) (FAILURE_BASE_RATE)

One product sold through a partner was about 37% of sales. The partner agreement expired and was not renewed, receivables ran above the company's own expected range, and gross margin fell in the same year as a large impairment and loss. The partner's product sales were $253.1 million (37% of net sales) in fiscal 2018 and $202.5 million (31%) in fiscal 2019 . Gross margin fell from 42% to 37%, the operating loss was $262.3 million including $375.4 million of impairment, and net income of $28.7 million became a net loss of $272.1 million . A single-product business with a long cash cycle can move from profit to a large loss in one year. Stallion's R-32 is its main product, and its cash conversion cycle is about 180 days, so this shape is the downside to test, not a remote case.

CHAPTER VII

Why the Price Is What It Is

> *"It would change a little bit."*
>
> — STALLION MANAGEMENT, ANSWERING WHETHER THE FY27 CONTRIBUTION OF ABOUT ₹250 CRORE FROM THE NEW PLANT STILL HELD, Q1 FY27 EARNINGS CALL, 17 AUGUST 2026

Now the question most readers wait for: is the price reasonable? I will answer it with arithmetic, not with a feeling about the stock. Start with what ₹187 buys. At this price the market values Stallion at about 2,172 crore, using the share count implied by the company's market value . Of that, about 400 crore is net cash, roughly 34 rupees a share. So the operating business is priced at about 1,773 crore, or about 153 rupees a share.

Keep the cash separate from the business. Most of it came from the rights issue, and it sits in bank deposits and bank balances . A rupee of cash is worth a rupee. A rupee of profit is worth whatever the market will pay for it, and that depends on whether the profit lasts.

The trailing earnings look expensive. On reported earnings of 3.94 rupees a share for the last four quarters, the stock trades at about 47 times. Two quarters explain most of the swing. June 2026 earned about 18.6 crore at an operating margin of 18 percent. September 2026 earned about 2.5 crore at an operating margin of 2 percent, with a tax charge of 57 percent . You should not average those into a verdict. You should ask why September was so weak, and the sources I read did not give a full answer.

A reverse DCF is the tool I use to turn a price into a question. You set a required return, a long-run growth rate and a number of years, and then ask what growth the price needs. I used a 12.5 percent cost of equity, 5 percent growth after ten years, and the FY26 profit of 43.8 crore as the starting point. I did not use free cash flow, because FY26 free cash flow was negative after plant spending . That is a weakness of the method, and I want you to see it before you see the answer.

The answer is that the price needs profit to grow at about 20 percent a year for ten years. Ten years of that compounding turns 43.8 crore into about 265 crore. At an 11 percent net

margin, that is about 2,400 crore of sales, more than five times FY26. Put that next to management's own target for FY28, sales above 1,100 crore , and you can see the gap. The market is paying for a plant programme to work, and then to keep working.

Now the scenarios. I value the business two years out, on FY28 profit. The bear case has sales flat at 430 crore and a 6 percent net margin. The base case has sales of 700 crore, which is about 27 percent a year growth and sits below the 30 to 35 percent a year that management has guided . It also has an 11 percent margin. The bull case has sales of 1,100 crore and a 14 percent margin, which is management's own figure. Each case gets a 30 times multiple on profit, plus the net cash per share.

The results are a bear value of about 101 rupees, a base value of about 233 and a bull value of about 432. The bull value is more than twice the price. The bear value is 46 percent below it. Notice that the bear case uses a 30 times multiple, which is generous for a business that earned a 6 percent margin in its weak year. At 15 times, the bear value falls to about 68 rupees, and that is the number I would want you to hold in your head when you hear the word bear.

Then the peers. Gujarat Fluorochemicals trades at about 76 times trailing earnings on a margin of 17 percent. Navin Fluorine trades at about 56 times on a margin of 30 percent and growth of 46 percent. SRF trades at about 32 times on an 18.8 percent margin on the vendor basis . Stallion is not cheap against SRF. On reported earnings it is priced higher, and it earns lower margins and a lower return on equity. The market is paying for what the plants will do, not for what the company has done.

So the price is not obviously wrong, and it is not obviously cheap either. It assumes a plant ramp, and the next chapter asks what the tape says about whether buyers believe it. Chapter 9 then weighs the two sides against each other and puts a number on the expected return.

Notice how much the answer depends on the method. The vendor sites show price-to-earnings ratios of 35 times, 47 times and 50 times for the same share price, and none of them is wrong on its own terms. One divides the price by reported earnings per share. Another divides market value by profit. A third uses a different earnings base altogether.

When the number moves that much with the method, the sensible move is to pick one basis, say what it is, and show the others, which is what this chapter does.

The ex-cash view is the one I trust most for this company, because the cash is large relative to the business. Strip out about 400 crore of net cash and the operating business is priced at about 1,773 crore. On trailing profit that is about 41 times. On the FY28 profit in our base case it is about 23 times. The difference is the bet on the plants. If the plants deliver the base case, today's price looks less stretched in two years. If they do not, the multiple stays high on a profit that has not grown.

A reader might ask why I do not simply compare Stallion with a list of cheap chemical stocks. Cheapness is a statement about the market's expectations, not about the business. The three peers in the prospectus are priced for growth and margins that Stallion has not shown. Matching their multiples would mean paying today for a margin that has not appeared. The useful question is not whether Stallion is cheap against them, but whether its own plants can close the gap, and on what timetable.

Before you move on, write down the number that matters most: the FY28 sales figure the company actually reports, set against 700 crore and 1,100 crore. That single line will tell you more about the price than any multiple in the table.

> **NARRATOR'S REFLECTION**
>
> Write the FY28 sales target next to today's price. If the price needs about 2,400 crore of sales at a ten-year growth path, you are not buying what the company earns today. You are buying the next ten years of plants, and you should price that risk on purpose.

CHAPTER VIII

The Tape

> *"Is the market confirming the business story, or is the stock still in a decline that the price has not yet left?"*
>
> — INSTITUTIONAL RESEARCH DESK MAXIM

On the tape. I want to be clear about what it can and cannot tell you. It is a record of what buyers and sellers agreed to pay in the last few months. It does not know whether the plants will work. It does tell you whether the crowd is paying for the story right now, and on 13 November the answer is that it is not.

The price closed at 187.12 rupees after a fall of about five percent on the day. Volume was about 2.7 times its usual level. A large fall on heavy volume is a different thing from a quiet slide. It can mean holders are reducing exposure, or it can mean the stock is being repriced after news. I could not find the delivery figures that would separate the two, so I hold that question open.

The averages tell the same story. The price is below the 10-day, 20-day, 50-day, 30-week and 10-week averages. It is above the 200-day average at 182.89, and that is the one long-term line still under it. Stage 4 is the label for a stock in that position, and the rule for a Stage 4 stock is simple. Do not buy it until it has built a base and broken out again.

I use a no-chase rule, which means no entry until the stock is inside its support zone and the zone holds. For Stallion, the support zone is 155 to 160 rupees, and the stop is 152.30. The price is about 17 percent above the top of that zone today. So the gate says no, and that is the answer I would give you whether or not I liked the business.

The levels come from the market's own structure. The first pivot sits at 157.43, inside the zone, and the second at 130.89 is the next structural floor if the first gives way. Above the price the obstacles are the 50-day average at 209 and the weekly averages just under 203. A repair would need a weekly close back above that band, on volume, and then it would need to hold.

Flow is the hardest part to see. I can read price and volume, but I cannot read who is trading. Promoter holding fell from about 68 percent to about 48 percent in six months. The filings I read do not explain why, and I have not claimed an explanation. A change that large should make you careful about the story the company tells, not because it is false, but because you have not yet seen the reason.

It helps to know the vocabulary. A Stage 1 stock is building a base after a decline. A Stage 2 stock is advancing, trading above a rising long-term average. A Stage 3 stock is topping out, and a Stage 4 stock is declining below a falling average. The working rule is to buy in Stage 2 and avoid Stage 4. That is simple to say and harder to apply, because a change of stage is only clear after it has happened. That is why this dossier waits for a zone to hold rather than predicting the bottom.

The 200-day average is the line I watch most closely here. At 182.89 rupees it is the one long-term average the price still sits above. It is a useful reference because it summarises roughly a year of trading. A close below it would turn a slow decline into a break of support, and that would make the zone at 155 to 160 more important, not less.

The 4-hour readings are the short-term instrument. They show whether a bounce is being bought or sold into. Here the 4-hour close sits below its 20-period average, and the 4-hour RSI at 37.7 is the lowest of the three timeframes. A stock that bounces on the daily chart while the 4-hour chart keeps falling is usually a stock where sellers use each rally to reduce, not one that has turned.

The volume reading needs care. Heavy volume on a down day is not, by itself, proof that large holders are leaving. Stocks fall on news, and the volume can simply reflect the repricing. What matters is what comes next. If the following sessions show volume drying up on down days and rising on up days, the message changes. If they show heavy selling into every rally, the message is the same as today's: the stock is still being sold.

The pivot levels deserve a note of their own. Pivots are calculated from the prior session's high, low and close, so they are mechanical, and that is both their strength and their limit. Traders watch them, which can make them self-fulfilling in the short run. The first pivot at

157.43 sits inside our zone for that reason. A break through it would tell you that the market, not just the formula, has stopped defending the level.

I would not trade a pivot on its own. I would use it as one of several lines that agree. Here the first pivot sits inside the support zone, and the zone lies well below the 40-week average at 190.51. Reaching it would mean a larger break of the recent trend. That is exactly why it is a useful place to test the stock, and also why it is not a promise that the price will hold.

So the tape is not a sell signal, and it is not a buy signal. It is a timing signal, and right now it says wait. Chapter 9 weighs that against the business and the price, and it puts numbers on the wait.

> **NARRATOR'S REFLECTION**
>
> Before you act on any chart, write down the level that would prove you wrong. For Stallion that is a weekly close under 152.30. If you cannot name the level, you are not analysing the stock. You are hoping.

CHAPTER IX

Both Sides, and the Decision

> *"Given what the business has shown, what the price assumes and what the tape says, is there a reason to own Stallion now, and if not, at what price?"*
>
> — INSTITUTIONAL RESEARCH DESK MAXIM

This is the chapter where the arguments meet, and I want to give each side its best case before I give my answer. The bull case is that the company has kept its promises so far. FY26 revenue was about 431 crore, profit was about 44 crore, and operating cash flow of about 39 crore met the level the company had set. The balance sheet has about 400 crore of net cash after the rights issue. A company with that cash and a plan to add capacity is not in a funding crisis.

The plants are late, but they are not gone. The R-32 plant has moved to the end of December 2026. The helium unit will run at low utilisation next year. The bull case says these are the first steps of a ramp, and that the regulatory freeze on hydrofluorocarbons from 2028 will favour the producer who already has capacity. If that ramp arrives on time, the 2028 bull case is arithmetically possible.

The bear case is equally direct. The business has not yet shown that it can earn steady profit on the capacity it already has. The June quarter had an operating margin of about 18 percent, and the September quarter had about 2 percent, with a tax charge of 57 percent. Operating cash flow was negative in two of the last three years. Refrigerant gases are most of the sales, imports are most of the costs, and the company has no long-term supply contracts with its main supplier country. Ten customers are about three-quarters of revenue.

The price already assumes the good version of the story. The reverse DCF says the market is paying for about 20 percent profit growth for a decade. The stock is in Stage 4, and it has fallen below most of its averages. The promoter stake fell by about twenty points in six months, and the filings I read do not say why. Those facts do not make this a failed business. They make the outcome wide, and a wide outcome should be paid for with a lower entry.

I put probabilities on the three outcomes. Thirty-five percent for the bear case, 45 for the base and 20 for the bull. Weighted, the two-year value is about 227 rupees, which is 21 percent above today's price. That sounds like a yes until you annualise it. It works out to about 10 percent a year, below the 12.5 percent return I require for this kind of risk. At 187 rupees, the stock does not pay enough.

The number that changes the answer is the price. At about 179 rupees the weighted value would just meet the hurdle. At the top of the support zone, about 160 rupees, the same weighted value is about 42 percent higher, or roughly 19 percent a year. That is why the entry is in the zone and not at today's price.

Let me say how I would size the idea, because sizing is where investors get hurt even when the analysis is right. The position is not sized on conviction. It is sized on the distance between the entry and the stop. From the top of the zone the stop sits about 4.7 percent below the entry, so a given amount of risk supports a much larger position than it would if the stop were 15 percent away. That keeps the loss small when the setup fails, which it sometimes does, and it puts the most capital where the stop is closest.

The probability weights are the most judgement-heavy part of the work, and I want to be open about them. I gave the bear case 35 percent because the plants have already slipped once and the margin in the latest quarter is weak. I gave the bull case 20 percent because it needs about 1,100 crore of sales in FY28, more than two and a half times FY26. If you think the bull case is more likely, the weighted value rises and the zone becomes more attractive. If you think the bear case is more likely, the reverse holds and the stop matters more.

What would change my mind about the bear case is simple to name. A clean R-32 start by the end of December, a second quarter with a margin back in the teens, and a management explanation of the September quarter that holds up when the numbers arrive would each move probability from the bear case toward the base. What would change my mind about the bull case is also simple. A slip of the R-32 start into next year, or a second weak quarter, would move probability away from it.

Cash is not free to hold. If the rupee sitting in cash could buy a stock that clears every gate today, waiting has a cost. The shortlist has names that clear the technical gate today, and this

dossier has not underwritten them, so I cannot say they are better. The discipline is the same for each. Fund a name from cash only when it has passed the evidence review and the price gate. Stallion gets no special exemption from that rule, and neither does any other name.

The alerts are not orders, and the reason matters. An alert tells you that the conditions for a fresh check have been met. It does not tell you that the stock will rise. The first alert, a daily close in the zone with volume at or below its average, starts the work of checking the evidence again. The second, a weekly close under 152.30, ends the setup. The third, a close above the 50-day average, starts a re-test of the trend. Treat each as a prompt to think, and make the decision with the evidence in front of you.

Suppose the price reaches 159 next month and the R-32 plant has not started. The discipline still says to look before buying. The zone and the plant are two separate conditions, and the zone alone is not enough. The stock may simply be falling further. In that case the right answer is to watch for a base and a repair on the weekly chart, and to accept that the entry may come on a second visit to the zone. We would rather miss a move than buy into a second leg down.

So the decision is wait. Not reject, because the business is not failing and the plants could work. Not buy now, because the price is too high for the uncertainty, the tape is in decline and the expected return is below what I need. Hold the list of events in mind: the R-32 start by the end of December, a half-year margin that comes back, a weekly close back above the averages, and a price that pays for the risk. When those line up, the answer may change.

Current holding decision: NOT HELD. 0 shares in the positions ledger; no current holding to trim or exit.. Stallion is not held in any account in the positions ledger, so there is no sale to recommend and no trim or exit to execute. The decision is about new capital only: wait for the support zone to hold on a closing basis, with the stop at ₹152.30 as the level that ends the setup. Cash keeps the next marginal rupee until the zone and the plant evidence line up. Alert plan: Daily close inside the ₹155.07 to ₹159.79 support zone, with volume at or below the 30-day average — Re-run the Stage 2 scan and the evidence checks in this dossier. No order; no shares are affected.; Weekly close below the ₹152.30 invalidation level — Remove the name from the entry list and close the setup. No order; no shares are affected.; Daily close above the 50-day average, on volume above the 30-day average — Start a re-test of the

trend and review the plant timetable. No order; no shares are affected. Capital redeployment: 100.00% to CASH (CASH): Retain the entire next marginal unit in cash.; Reallocate only when an equity candidate clears the current evidence, technical and risk/reward gates.; 0.00% to SHORTLIST (SHORTLIST): No active-shortlist name is funded from this marginal cash unit in this dossier.; Reassess shortlist candidates only with a fresh same-session snapshot, a completed evidence review and a confirmed support setup.; 0.00% to OUTSIDE (OUTSIDE): No outside candidate is funded.; Fund only after a separate evidence-backed review identifies a candidate with current entry asymmetry.

Options and Call-Convexity Playbook (NOT OPTIONABLE OR ILLIQUID): STALLION has no liquid listed options chain (not in NSE F&O segment) — express any thesis strictly via cash equity.

> **NARRATOR'S REFLECTION**
>
> Write down the price you would pay and the event you need to see before you pay it. For Stallion the price is inside 155 to 160 rupees and the event is the plants starting. If the price arrives first and the plant does not, the answer is still wait.

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